

Haonan Li

SENIOR RESEARCH SCIENTIST AT INSTITUTE OF FOUNDATION MODELS

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Profile

- Senior Research Scientist at the Institute of Foundation Models (IFM), MBZUAI, focusing on **LLM post-training & data engineering**.
 - Core contributor to open-source models: K2 (70B) JAIS, K2-Think (32B), and K2-V2 (70B). K2-Think is the world's fastest open-source AI model and the **most advanced open-source AI reasoning system** ever created. JAIS was the **world's most advanced Arabic LLM** at release.
 - I led the evaluation of JAIS, co-led the data curation of K2-V2, and co-led the RL training of K2-Think. We proposed the DALU algorithm, which **enabled RL training for LLMs with 2× longer context length and achieved ~10% improvement on multiple reasoning benchmarks, including AIME25 and Live-CodeBench**.
- Before IFM, I was Co-founder and CTO at LibrAI, where we developed several products and open-source projects for safe, autonomous AI systems.
 - I led the Libra-Eval and Libra-Leaderboard projects, which support automatic evaluation across **50+ safety datasets** and **involve more than 30 researchers from top universities and institutes**.
 - I led the development of the fact-verification tool Loki, which has received **over 1,000 stars** and outperformed concurrent releases from major research labs by 2× in community adoption.

Education

- 2018-2022 **PhD in Computer Science**, The University of Melbourne, Australia
Thesis: Incorporating Structured and Unstructured Information for Geospatial Question Answering
Supervisors: Prof. Timothy Baldwin, A/Prof. Martin Tomko, Dr. Maria Vasardani
- 2013-2017 **BSc in Computer Science**, Shanghai Jiao Tong University, China
Supervisor: Prof. Hai Zhao

Experience

- 2025- **Senior Research Scientist**, Institute of Foundation Models, UAE
- 2023-2025 **Postdoc Researcher**, MBZUAI, UAE
- 2023-2025 **CTO**, LibrAI, UAE
- 2019-2021 **Teaching Assistant**, The University of Melbourne, Australia
Taught ML and NLP courses to 100+ graduate students across two semesters
- 2020-2021 **Research Intern**, Microsoft Research Asia, China
Conducted research in NLP, resulting in two publications in top-tier conferences
- 2017-2018 **Algorithm Intern**, Horizontal Robotics, China
- 2015-2016 **Software Engineering Intern**, Intel Corporation, China

Recent Projects

2025-	K2-Think and K2-V2 Core Member. LLM Post-training, includes data creation, SFT, and RL algorithm.
2024-2025	Agentfly Project Lead. Novel framework for Agent training.
2024-2025	Libra-Eval and Libra-Leaderboard Project Lead. First comprehensive LLM leaderboard integrating both safety and capability metrics. Covers 50+ safety datasets using a unified framework.
2024	Loki Project Lead. An open-source fact verification tool that achieved 1,000+ GitHub stars, outperforming concurrent releases from major research labs by 2x in community adoption.
2023	LM-Evaluation-Harness Author and Contributor. A widely-adopted open-source framework for generative language model evaluation, used by numerous research labs and companies.
2023	JAIS Core Member of the Evaluation Team. Led evaluation efforts for JAIS.
2023	Do-Not-Answer Lead Author. Framework for evaluating LLM safeguards, featured in Stanford AI Index 2024 as a key safety assessment tool.
2023	CMMLU Lead Author. The most comprehensive Chinese LLM benchmark, adopted by all major Chinese LLM releases and becoming the de facto standard for Chinese language model evaluation.

Technical Skills

Languages:	Python, C++
ML/AI Libraries:	PyTorch, Transformers, PEFT, TRL, Ray, Accelerate
LLM Tools:	DeepSpeed, Megatron-LM, vLLM, SGLang, Flash Attention
Infra & Monitor:	Weights & Biases, Docker, AWS, Azure
Design & Dev:	Figma, LaTeX, Git

Honours and Achievements

2023	Silver Grant Award, MBZUAI Incubation and Entrepreneurship Center for LibrAI
2023	Pre-seed Investment from MiraclePlus for LibrAI
2021-2022	First Place, CommonGen Public Leaderboard (Maintained for 8 months)
2021	Stars of Tomorrow Award, Microsoft Research Asia Internship Program
2019	Second Place, SemEval-2019 Task 12: Toponym Resolution in Scientific Papers
2018	Melbourne Research Scholarship (3-year Full Scholarship), University of Melbourne
2015	Second Class Award, National Mathematics League Match for Undergraduate
2015	Excellence Award, Microsoft China Hackathon
2015	Honorable Mention, Mathematical Contest in Modeling (MCM)
2014	Second Class Award, National Mathematics League Match for Undergraduate
2012	First Class Award, National Mathematics League Match (Senior High School)
2011	Second Class Award, National Mathematics League Match (Senior High School)

Publications (Overview)

Around 2,200 citations and h-index of 23 (Google Scholar, 2026 Jan).
 Around 20 publications in top-tier venues like ICLR/Neurips/ACL/EMNLP.
 Google Scholar Profile: <https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=IqfgexsAAAAJ&hl=en&authuser=1>